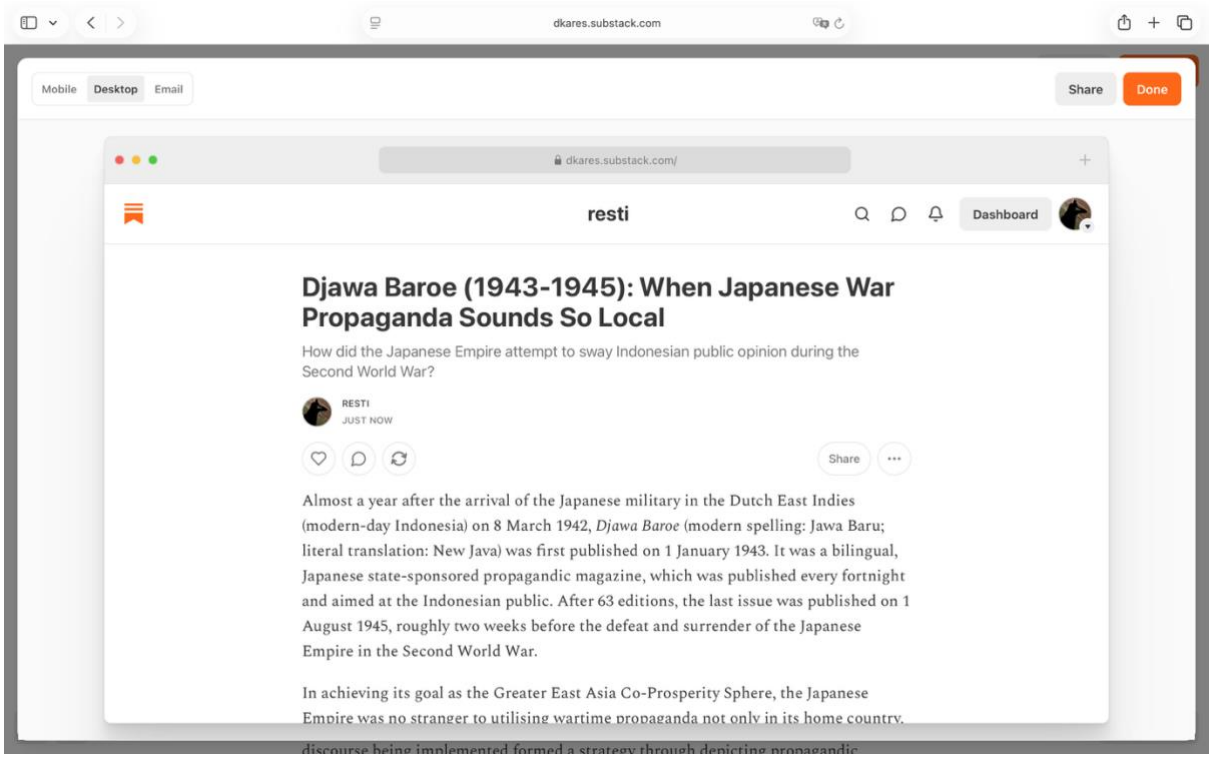
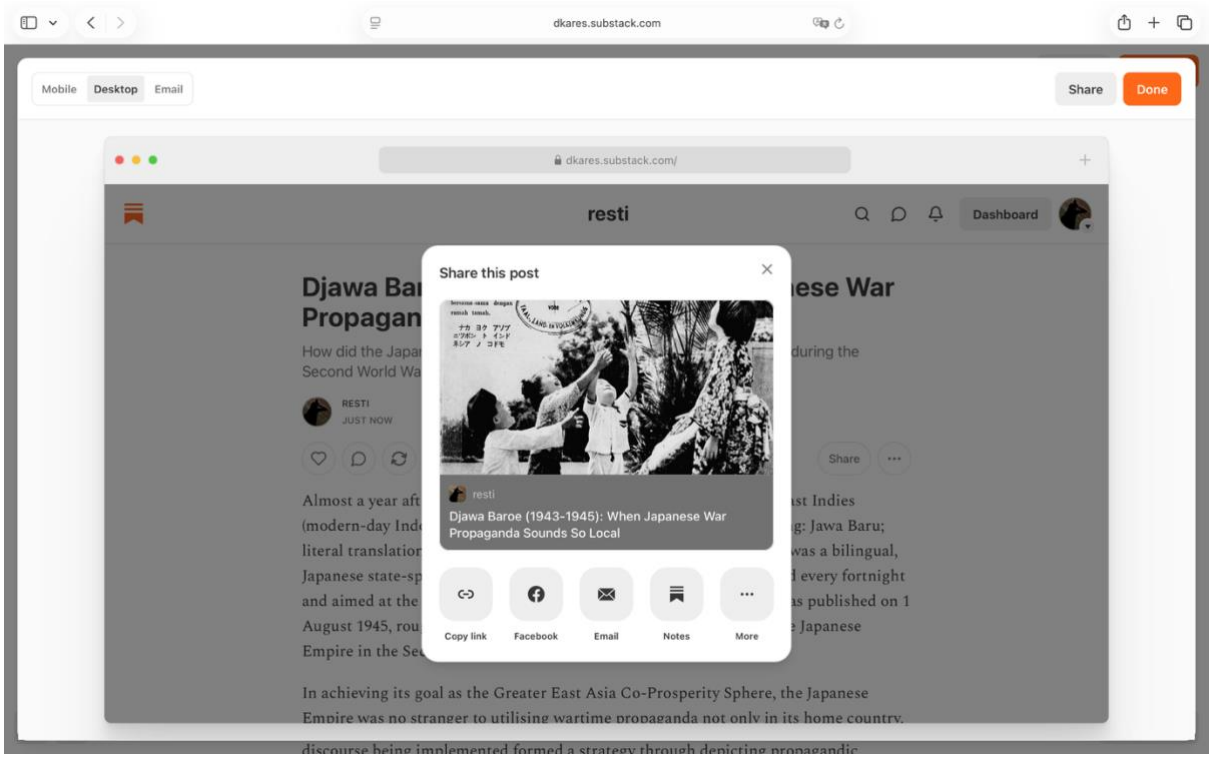
Project by Dwika Resti Putri, Goethe University Frankfurt am Main

Publication: Substack





Djawa Baroe (1943-1945): When Japanese War Propaganda Sounds So Local

How did the Japanese Empire attempt to sway Indonesian public opinion during the Second World War?

Almost a year after the arrival of the Japanese military in the Dutch East Indies (modern-day Indonesia) on 8 March 1942, *Djawa Baroe* (modern spelling: Jawa Baru; literal translation: New Java) was first published on 1 January 1943. It was a bilingual, Japanese state-sponsored propagandic magazine, which was published every fortnight and aimed at the Indonesian public. After 63 editions, the last issue was published on 1 August 1945, roughly two weeks before the defeat and surrender of the Japanese Empire in the Second World War.

In achieving its goal as the Greater East Asia Co-Prosperity Sphere, the Japanese Empire was no stranger to utilising wartime propaganda not only in its home country, but also in the occupied territories. In 1937, the new nationalist discourse was established to promote the Japanese nationalist ideology and encourage its people to take part in the war effort, blurring the lines between the fights happening at the battlefront and the domestic lives led on the home front (Yamashita, Kushner). The discourse being implemented formed a strategy through depicting propagandic aesthetics, such as a blend of patriotic imagery and domestic life illustrated in war songs, textbooks, and other visual media, aimed at invoking emotional engagement to mobilise war efforts. As an extension of this nationalist narrative, the Japanese Empire implemented a similar attitude in each of its occupied territories; however, with a hybridity flavour designated to each occupied territory. Thus, *Djawa Baroe* was conceived as the 'communicative bridge' for Indonesians to support the Japanese Empire under the narrative of Asian brotherhood against what they called the Western imperialists during the Occupation (1942-1945). However, as the Allies kept inching on the Japanese military and local insurrections started to spread like wildfire, the militaristic narrative in *Djawa Baroe* grew increasingly apparent. This project examines the trend progression represented in the aesthetics of *Djawa Baroe* in depicting Japanese Empire propaganda from 1943 to 1945.

Inclusivity as a gateway

Initially, the Japanese Empire presented itself as the Older Brother that liberates Indonesian people from the clutches of Dutch colonialism. As a proponent of erasing Dutch influence in the East Indies, the Japanese Empire introduced itself through the depiction of inclusivity by positioning Japanese and Indonesian people as equal, as represented on the covers of *Djawa Baroe*.

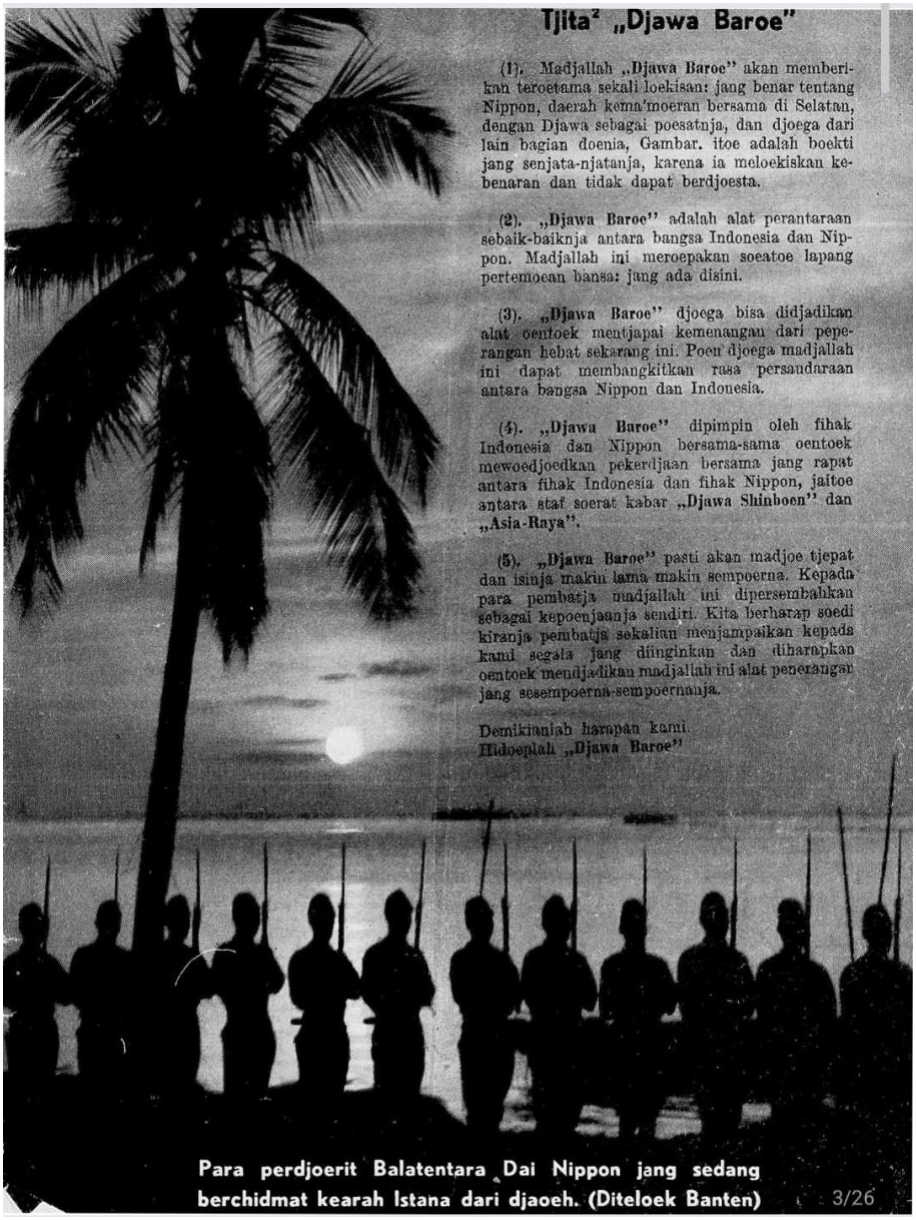


The cover of the first issue of Djawa Baroe, published on 1 January 1943, depicts a Japanese child and Indonesian children happily playing together.



The cover of Djawa Baroe, published on 1 January 1944, depicts an Indonesian woman dressing up in kimono while smiling at a Japanese woman.

On the very first issue, published on 1 January 1943, *Djawa Baroe* dedicated an entire page to declaring its mission as an attempt to appease the Indonesian audience.



Tjita² „Djawa Baroe"

(1). Madjallah „Djawa Baroe" akan memberikan teroetama sekali loekisan: jang benar tentang Nippon, daerah kema'moeran bersama di Selatan, dengan Djawa sebagai poesatnja, dan djoega dari lain bagian doenia, Gambar. itoe adalah boekti jang senjata-njatanja, karena ia meloekiskan kebenaran dan tidak dapat berdjoesta.

(2). „Djawa Baroe" adalah alat perantaraan sebaik-baiknja antara bangsa Indonesia dan Nippon. Madjallah ini meroepakan soeatoe lapang pertemoean bansa: jang ada disini.

(3). „Djawa Baroe" djoega bisa didjadikan alat oentoek mentjapai kemenangan dari peperangan hebat sekarang ini. Poen djoega madjallah ini dapat membangkitkan rasa persaudaraan antara bangsa Nippon dan Indonesia.

(4). „Djawa Baroe" dipimpin oleh fihak Indonesia dan Nippon bersama-sama oentoek mewoedjoedkan pekerdjaan bersama jang rapat antara fihak Indonesia dan fihak Nippon, jaitoe antara staf soerat kabar „Djawa Shinboen" dan „Asia-Raya".

(5). „Djawa Baroe" pasti akan madjoe tjepat dan isinja makin lama makin sempoerna. Kepada para pembatja madjallah ini dipersembahkan sebagai kepoenjaanja sendiri. Kita berharap soedi kiranja pembatja sekalian menjampaikan kepada kami segala jang diinginkan dan diharapkan oentoek mendjadikan madjallah ini alat penerangan jang sesempoerna-sempoernanja.

Demikianlah harapan kami.
Hidoeplah „Djawa Baroe"

Para perdjoerit Balatentara Dai Nippon jang sedang berchidmat kearah Istana dari djaoeh. (Diteloek Banten)

3/26

The very first issue of Djawa Baroe displays the manifesto that declares the magazine would be a meeting bridge for Japan and Indonesia and would only publish the "truth" in order to support Japan (Nippon) during the war.

The magazine itself was aimed at an educated Indonesian audience, while at the same time, it promoted Japanese literacy through language crash-course rubrics, and other content such as war songs and comic strips.



連載小説

本道に還へる(1)

アンヂャル アスマラ作

【梗概】第二次世界大戦の序幕ともいふべき蘭領印度が始つた時、西洋教育を受けて新進になつてゐるインドネシア人の見本のやうなハミツドは、バレンバンで某会社の課長として勤務てゐた。ハミツドは混血ハーフカスト——ヨーロツパ人とインドネシア人の間に一の娘と婚約して居り、全く西洋人気取りで自分の国族とすらも交際を断つてゐた。その時、彼の叔父ハヂー・ムスタツファは遥くからハミツドを慕はて来て豪大な家を借げた。といふのは、ハミツドの父が死んだから、その遺言では大きな遺産をハミツドに残へる。——但し彼の叔父であるムスタツファの娘、つまり彼の従妹にあたるヌルシニと結婚するといふ条件の下にだといふのである。

これはムスタツファに取つてもデリケートな問題であつた。自分の娘を他の男にでも、特にハーフカストの娘と無理に結婚してゐる男嫌のハミツドに、押しつけて結婚させるといふことは好ましいことでなかつた。だが、これは兄の最後の遺言であつて見れば、衆聞としてもこれを放つて置くわけに行かない。ところで、ハミツドは素朴したやうに、自分と同族の土人の娘を嫌ひ——彼女は自分を劣等民族視さなどとひ——この叔父の愛らしい従妹には耳を傾けようとしなかつた。ハヂー・ムスタツファは彼のこに兄が死の際子に遺した数千ギルダーの金を抱へて 途方に暮れてジヤワに渡り、その金は銀行へ預けた。

大東亜戦争が勃発した時、ハミツドは志願兵としてオランダ軍に投じたといふ噂であつた。彼はそのハーフカストの血を少々ひそある理由と一緒に住むやうに取り計らした。バレンバンの地獄では、オランダ軍もイギリス軍も潰滅し、退却した。ハミツドは、多数の民間人捕虜収容所を設立して、ジヤワに走つた。そして、噂に聞はうと彼女がゐる者の叔父の家を訪ねた。然し、姿はゐない。その彼の失踪は極秘な捕虜に属つた。彼女達は皆の婦人と一緒にどこかへ連行されつたことが分つたからである。ハミツドは家もなく、友もなく、仕事もなく、全くの失業の孤客である自分自身を発見した。そして放心状態で、日本軍がスマトラへ入城して来るのを無聊して待つる間更を、ぼんやり見てゐた。彼の心の奥底はヨーロツパ人であるので、インドネシア人等の前途こんなに無聊して日本軍を迎へるのか、不思議だとさへ思つた。

それから数週間の日時が経過した。その間に新しい世界の夜が明けたので ハミツドはいろいろの事を知り、悟り出した。自分はインドネシア人であり乍ら、ヨーロツパ人の特権階級に立してゐたに過ぎない。

ハミツドが彼女ムスタツファの家を訪ねた時から、彼の一生の最大な転換期であつた。彼はスの結婚早々と言渡した彼女の従妹ヌルシニに会つた。美しい娘である。健康な東洋風のしつかりした骨格された彼女の容姿は、ハミツドの眼を開かせた。インドネシア人たることを誇とするこの美しい娘は、嫌悪したる持つたハミツドに人生の希望を与へた。ハミツドは遂に新たなる決意をした——日本軍に仕へ、自分に新しい祖国との結合を強り選へしてくれたこの娘と結婚しやう……と。(つづく)

ニツポン ゴ ノ ハツオン

ア	イ	ウ	エ	オ	a	i	oe	é	o
カ	キ	ク	ケ	コ	ka	ki	koe	ké	ko
ガ	ギ	グ	ゲ	ゴ	ga	gi	goe	gé	go
サ	シ	ス	セ	ソ	sa	si	soe	sé	so
ザ	ジ	ズ	ゼ	ゾ	dja	dji	djoe	djé	djo
タ	チ	ツ	テ	ト	ta	tji	tsoe	té	to
ダ	ヂ	ヅ	デ	ド	da	dji	dzoe	dé	do
ナ	ニ	ヌ	ネ	ノ	na	ni	noe	né	no
ハ	ヒ	フ	ヘ	ホ	ha	hi	hoe	hé	ho
バ	ビ	ブ	ベ	ボ	ba	bi	boe	bé	bo
パ	ピ	プ	ペ	ポ	pa	pi	poe	pé	po
マ	ミ	ム	メ	モ	ma	mi	moe	mé	mo
ヤ	(イ)	ユ	(エ)	ヨ	ja	(i)	joe	(é)	jo
ラ	リ	ル	レ	ロ	ra	ri	roe	ré	ro
ワ	キ	(ウ)	ヱ	ヲ	wa	wi	(oe)	wé	wo
ン					n				
キャ	キュ	キョ			kja	kjoe	kjo		
ギャ	ギュ	ギョ			gja	gjoe	gjo		
シャ	シュ	ショ			sja	sjoe	sjo		
ジャ	ジュ	ジョ			zja	zjoe	zjo		
チャ	チュ	チョ	チェ		tja	tjoe	tjo	tjé	
ヂャ	ヂュ	ヂョ			dja	djoe	djo		
ニャ	ニュ	ニョ			nja	njoe	njo		
ヒャ	ヒュ	ヒョ			hja	hjoe	hjo		
ビャ	ビュ	ビョ			bja	bjoe	bjo		
ピャ	ピュ	ピョ			pja	pjoe	pjo		
ミャ	ミュ	ミョ			mja	mjoe	mjo		
リャ	リュ	リョ			rja	rjoe	rjo		

Tjaranja Melisankan Bahasa Nippon.

ジヤワ バルー

昭和十八年一月一日発行
(月二回・毎月一日・十五日発行)
発行兼印刷人 鈴木文四郎
定価 一部 十五 錢
三ケ月 七十五 錢
(すべて前金のこと)
発行所 ジヤワ新聞社
ジヤカルタ市モーレンブリート北

各 地	ジヤワ新聞販売店
各 地	アンアラヤ販売店
スラバヤ	スアラアシア新聞販売部
バンドン	チヤハヤ新聞販売部
ジョクジヤ	ジナーマカン新聞販売部
スマラン	シナーバル新聞販売部
各地書店	
ジヤワ新聞社	

Djawa Baroe

Terbit pada 1 Jan: 2603.
(Terbit 2 × seboelan, tiap tgl: 1. — 15.)
Pemimpin penerbit D. Somoeki
Harga satoe f 0.15
2 Boelan f 0.75
(Dibajar lebih dahoeloe)
Penerbit DJAWA SJINBOEN SJA
Molenvliet O. 8, Djakarta

Tempat Minta Berlangganan.

Dimana-mana kompol agen	Djawa Sjinboen
Dimana-mana tempat agen	Asia Raya
Soerabaja adm:	„Soeara Asia"
Bandjarmasin adm:	„Tjahaja"
Djakja adm:	„Sinar Matahari"
Semarang adm:	„Sinar Baroe"
Dimana-mana tempat	Toko' Boekoe
Kantor	Djawa Sjinboen

The language section on the issue published in 1943.



BEKERDJA

TEMPO DI MARCIA

LAGOE : NOBUO IIDA
LJAJAR : INOE KERTOPATI
KEIMIN BUNKA SHIDOSHO, DJT.03

2. Bekerdja, bekerdja, bekerdja.
Tiada satoe bertopan dagoe
Ditengah sawah penoeh berloempoer
Tani membadjak mengajoen tjangkoel
Semoea petani giat gembira
Tenaga pekerdja tegoeh bersatoe
Goegoer hantjoer kaoem sekoetoe

3. Bekerdja, bekerdja, bekerdja.
Tiada satoe doedoek termenoeng
Kaoem nelajan melajar laoet
Melawan badai ombak gemoeroeh
Semoea petani giat gembira
Tenaga pekerdja tegoeh bersatoe
Goegoer hantjoer kaoem sekoetoe.

Lagoe : „BEKERDJA"

TIAP-TIAP kata haroes tegas dioetjapkan. Hendaknja dinjanjikan seolah-olah menderapkan kaki diatas tanah. Dan rasakanlah kegembiraan bekerdja dalam lagoe ini dengan meresapkan benar-benar arti sja'irnja.

Diharap dengan sangat, soepaja seroean persatoean tenaga ra'jat oentoek membela Tanah Air dengan perantaraan irama lagoe: „*Bekerdja*" ini akan bergelora dari paberik, dari desa di goenoeng, dari doesoen di-pantai, dari segala tempat.

Noboeo Iida.

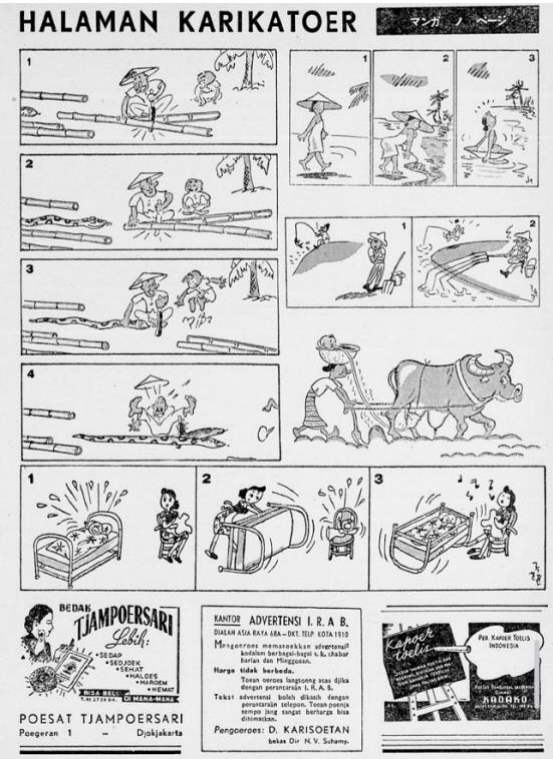
ジヤワ バルー (第一号)
昭和十九年一月一日発行
(月二回・毎月一日・十五日発行)
発行兼印刷人 野村秀次
印刷所兼発行所 越島晉次
定価 一部 二十 錢
(すべて前金のこと)
発行所 ジヤワ新聞社
ジヤカルタ市モーレンブリート町

Djawa Baroe (1)

Terbit pada 1 Djanoeari 2604.
(Terbit 2 × seboelan, tiap tgl. 1 dan 15).
Pemimpin penerbit H. Nomoera
„ pentjetak Z. Kosjidjima
Harga satoe f 0.20
(Dibajar lebih dahoeloe)
Penerbit DJAWA SJINBOEN SJA
Molenvliet T. 8, Djakarta

34

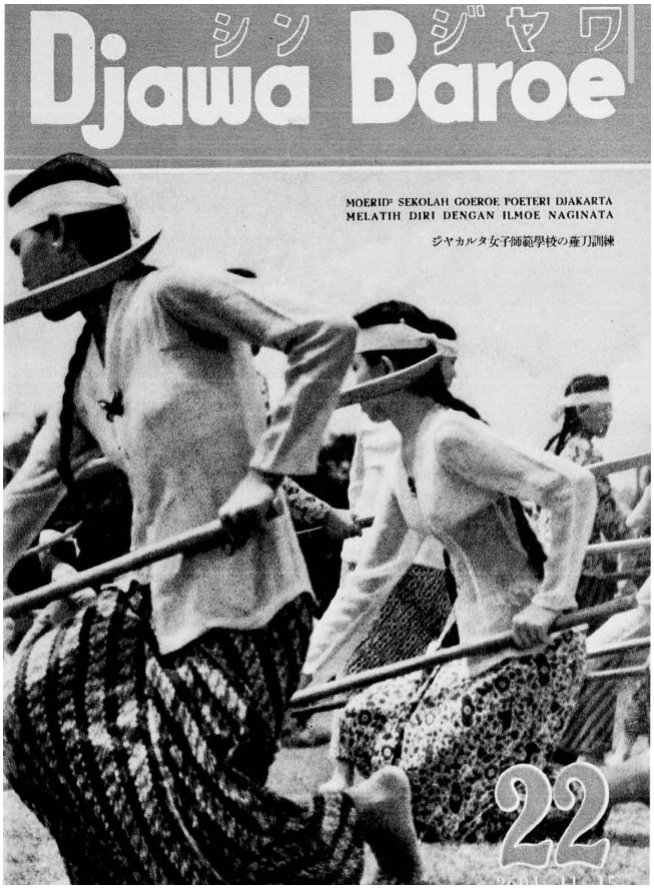
The music section on the magazine, published in 1944, contains the message of the importance of Work (Bekerdja) in support of not only domestic life but also for the greater war purposes.



The comic strips, published in 1944, adopts the local flavour by portraying the life at the farm and life as a mother. Domestic advertisement is also displayed at the bottom of the page.

The irony of the women's representations

Djawa Baroe often depicts women and girls as both equal soldiers in the field and in more domestic portraits. This was very much in contrast to the reality of kidnapping and sexual slavery, committed by the Japanese military.



The cover of Djawa Baroe, published on 15 November 1944 portrays female soldiers wearing traditional Javanese kebaya.



Moerid² sekolah poeteri jang mendengarkan dengan telaten. 熱心に聞き入る女學生たち

PERLOEMBAAN

Pada masa ini oentoek membantoe Dai Nippon adalah penting sekali bagai bangsa Indonesia.

Oentoek membantoe Dai Nippon, haroes mempeladjari bahasa Nippon terlebih dahoeloe, dan djika soedah faham bahasa Nippon, begitoepoen djika soedah mendapat Nippon Seishin (Semangat Nippon) oentoek mengetahoei lebih dalam tjita² Nippon jang soetji dan moerni didalam doenia ini, soedah tentoe bantoean kepada Nippon akan berhasil dengan sendirinja.

Seperti telah dioemoemkan dida am soerat² kabar, dalam beberapa ari jang laloe dalam permoesjawara.an para Kenchoo² ada 2 Kenchoo jang memberi pelapoeran dengan menggoenakan bahasa Nippon jang sangat mengagoemkan sekali kepada sekalian jang hadlir.

Njatalah disini bahwa perasaan Indonesia terhadap Nippon semakin lama semakin rapat, jang mana

On the same issue, Djawa Baroe portrays Indonesian female students in the middle of a lecture.



The women's parade (Parade Kaoem Wanita) on Djawa Baroe, published on 1 January 1944, portraying various women and girls who appear willingly in support of the Japanese Empire.

When soft power could no longer contain the urgency



The message in the advertisement becomes more obvious: one must take care of their health so they can fight for the Japanese Empire (published on 15 January 1945)

In the earlier issues, *Djawa Baroe* also depicted Indonesian influential figures such as Sukarno and Moh. Hatta, who later became the first President and Vice-President of the Republic of Indonesia, in a positive light as young anti-Western-imperialist politicians who worked in tandem with the Japanese Empire. However, as the Japanese military became

increasingly desperate, the narrative in *Djawa Baroe* followed suit. Censorship was also prominent, even though the Indonesians who worked in the magazine would still have access to the uncensored articles and news (Widjanarko). Despite the censorship, the reality of the war and the spread of the message underground eventually leads to domino effect, resulting in the declaration of indepedence of the Republic of Indonesia on 17 August 1945, two days after the surrender of the Japanese Empire.

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